SABLE HARBOR

LEGAL RECORDS
FULL SOURCE EDITION

Draft publication design · exact-file review required

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ENTERPRISE SUPPORT SERVICES AND INDEPENDENCE DOCTRINE

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Enterprise Support Services

Enterprise Support Services (ESS) is the administrative umbrella for Sable Harbor's enterprise support functions. The name is intentionally ordinary. ESS is not an enterprise command center, COO substitute, risk czardom, or shadow management layer.

ESS administratively groups the principal support institutions, including:

- Office of the General Counsel, including Corporate Secretary;
- Risk & Compliance;
- Finance;
- People & Culture;
- Enterprise Technology Services;
- enterprise security/CISO capability;
- procurement and vendor/supply-chain support;
- enterprise safety/environmental governance where appropriate;
- quality/technical standards stewardship where appropriate;
- facilities/workplace services; and
- continuity/crisis coordination as a standing Corporate Secretary/ESS responsibility rather than a separate resilience empire.

Internal Audit may receive ESS administrative support and may be associated with the headquarters support environment, but it is **not** substantively part of Risk & Compliance, OGC, Finance, or another ESS operating function.

Chief of ESS

The **Chief of ESS** is the administrative head of the umbrella, not the substantive superior of every corporate officer housed within it. The role coordinates shared administration, budget mechanics, facilities, staffing support, service quality, and cross-functional coherence.

Membership in ESS does **not** imply that the CFO, General Counsel, senior People & Culture leader, technology leader, CISO, or other substantive officer loses direct standing with the CEO or Board where the office's responsibilities require it. The Chief of ESS cannot convert administrative coordination into generalized approval authority.

Substantive reporting and professional lines

The General Counsel has direct standing with the Chief Executive Officer and Board when professional duties require it. OGC owns legal advice and Corporate Secretary mechanics; it does not become a substitute management chain.

Risk & Compliance is a combined management challenge/co-ordination function. Management owns risks and controls. Risk & Compliance builds compliance architecture, risk visibility, policy/control co-ordination, CCF stewardship, and escalation, but does not acquire ordinary operating authority.

Finance owns authoritative financial truth and enterprise financial standards while remaining bounded on business judgment as defined in controlling corporate doctrine.

People & Culture owns the enterprise people-system profession and employee experience; it does not own every manager's human responsibilities.

Technology Services owns shared technology capability and platforms while product/business engineering remains with the businesses.

The CISO maintains an independent security authority boundary proportionate to material security obligations and does not become a generalized veto office.

Internal Audit independence

Internal Audit is structurally separate from OGC, Risk & Compliance, Finance, Technology Services, J2, and management control ownership. Internal Audit reports **functionally to the Board Audit & Compliance Committee**. Administrative matters may flow through the CEO/ESS environment only where they do not impair audit independence.

No ESS leader may suppress, pre-clear, edit for convenience, or condition an Internal Audit communication to the Audit & Compliance Committee. Internal Audit controls audit scope, methods, findings, and communications subject to its charter and committee oversight.

Independence doctrine

Sable Harbor preserves separate challenge mechanisms because combining them would weaken all of them.

1. **Management owns the business and its risks.** Operating leaders own controls, remediation, performance, and risk inside delegated authority.
2. **OGC advises lawfully.** Legal identifies legal boundaries and lawful paths without substituting for management judgment.
3. **Risk & Compliance challenges and co-ordinates.** It does not become the enterprise decision-maker.
4. **Finance states financial truth.** Financial authority does not silently become operating command.
5. **Internal Audit independently evaluates.** It does not own the activities it audits.
6. **J2 remains separate.** J2 establishes Contact, forms Judgment, provides Orientation, and supports learning. It is not Internal Audit, Compliance, Legal, Finance, Security, or Risk.

Internal Audit may audit J2 or ESS processes when within scope. J2 may surface facts or uncertainty relevant to Internal Audit. Neither supervises the other.

Physical design

ESS functions may share buildings and service infrastructure for administrative efficiency. Internal Audit should remain physically distinct—such as a separate secured floor/suite—even where located in the same headquarters complex.

J2 is physically separate from ESS. Future Sacramento headquarters floor plans must preserve these distinctions while allowing ordinary collaboration.

Anti-empire rule

ESS exists to support the enterprise. It may not convert legal review, compliance/risk work, finance, people services, technology, security, procurement, safety, quality, or administrative convenience into generalized approval rights over ordinary business decisions unless a specific law, board-reserved matter, policy, or delegated authority expressly requires it.

The governing principle is: **challenge and support must be strong; authority must remain explicit.**